TABLE III

MAIN RESULTS.

	Pr(Enroll in Flagship), Treated Group				Average Effect on Outcomes			
	Base	+ Mech.	+ Info	% Info	ΔGPA	ΔPersist	ΔSTEM	ΔPayoff
A. Texas Top Ten								
(1): TTP	24.72	2.81	6.33	69.23	0.71	15.66	10.46	−0.56
	(1.05)	(0.19)	(0.4)	(1.98)	(0.06)	(2.8)	(3.29)	(0.1)
(2) +Aware	24.5	3.01	6.82	69.36	0.72	15.45	9.74	−0.59
	(1.03)	(0.25)	(0.57)	(1.97)	(0.07)	(2.94)	(3.51)	(0.08)
B. Automatic Admission by $z^{admit}\gamma$								
(3): Top 5%	42.84	1.88	3.21	62.98	0.2	3.02	4.56	0.02
	(2.41)	(0.25)	(0.41)	(2.38)	(0.11)	(7.3)	(12.19)	(1.54)
(4): Top 10%	39.35	2.39	4.4	64.79	0.38	6.16	8.53	0.0
	(1.97)	(0.25)	(0.42)	(2.3)	(0.06)	(5.05)	(7.43)	(0.88)
(5): Top 15%	36.81	2.66	5.07	65.6	0.53	8.69	11.57	−0.05
	(1.73)	(0.24)	(0.42)	(2.23)	(0.07)	(3.96)	(5.16)	(0.56)
(6): Top 20%	34.67	2.88	5.7	66.39	0.68	11.42	14.71	−0.13
	(1.49)	(0.24)	(0.42)	(2.14)	(0.07)	(2.74)	(3.21)	(0.3)

Note: This table shows a decomposition of changes in flagship enrollment for treated households, and average impacts on academic outcomes and programs' payoffs. "Base": Share of "treated" group enrolling at baseline. "Mech": Mechanical effect. "Info": Information effect. "% Info": Share of total increase in treated-group enrollment due to information. Outcomes: Total change in outcome (GPA, 1(Persist), 1(Persist and major in STEM), college payoff) / measure of top-decile students induced to enroll in flagships by mechanical and informative effects; this is equivalent to the average difference in outcomes between these students and the students they displaced. Standard errors in parentheses.

Academic Outcomes. Columns 5 through 7 of Table III show average differences in post-enrollment outcomes between the students who were "pulled in" and the nontop-decile students that they displaced from flagships in equilibrium. I report cumulative GPA, an indicator for persistence through 2 years, an indicator for persistence and majoring in STEM. Top-decile students induced to enroll by the mechanical and informative effects earn higher GPAs, are 16 percentage points more likely to persist, and 10 percentage points more likely to persist and choose a STEM major, than are the students that they displaced.[25]

Past studies have found that less-prepared students may select out of STEM majors (Arcidiacono, Aucejo, and Hotz (2016)). I do not find that this is the case for the percent plan. In practice, the University of Texas at Austin had a separate, selective admissions process for engineering majors. I abstract from this in my estimates. However, if lower demand would lead to lower admissions standards for those majors in a world without the percent plan, then my results might overstate the impacts of the percent plan on the number of STEM majors.

The final column of Table III considers the average payoff $E(\pi_{ij})$ that the program receives. Flagship program payoffs π_{ij} would fall when top-decile students are automatically admitted, suggesting the presence of a trade-off.[26]

[25] This calculation considers students enrolling in flagships. In Supplemental Appendix E.4, I present evidence of overall gains in persistence across all institutions.

[26] The coefficient $\gamma^{\text{admit}}_{\text{classrank}}$ is approximately $-.24$ per decile; hence program payoffs fall by the equivalent of admitting a top-40% rather than top-decile student all else equal.